Post 1

Q1 was the hardest quarter I've ever had since starting my business

Client engagements were ending (or already had). Pipeline was looking pretty thin going into the second half of January.

And then another client let me know we were going to wrap up early Feb.

I was down to two clients with virtually no pipeline.

This left me feeling really vulnerable.

Everything was ok, but another engagement ending would've been a really
tough pill to swallow.

By late January, I had come up with a plan to build pipeline.

Double down on LinkedIn. Go to as many events as possible. Ask for intros. Follow up with leads that never got back to me or said "maybe later"

And for the first time, do some direct outreach.

This wasn't cold outreach, this was outreach to folks in my network to pitch them on my various offerings.

I wasn't desperate, but I felt like I had to take aggressive action if I wanted things to change in Q2.

In short, I needed to increase my luck surface area

After all that, by late Feb, I still had nothing.

No new business, pipeline looking marginally better but that was it.

Every sales call I took I lost.

I felt completed defeated.

My confidence was shook.

I wasn't really sure what to do.

I told myself to trust the process.

That all the work that I had been doing in Q4 and over the last couple months was going to payoff eventually. I just had to be patient.

And sure enough, looking ahead to Q2, pipeline is looking much better.

I closed a new client that I'm really excited about and am exploring a couple projects that I'm eager to get off the ground.

What did I learn from this experience?

More than anything else, to trust myself and trust the process.

I'm always out meeting new people, taking calls, doing intros and posting on LinkedIn.

Together, these activities together keep my pipeline healthy and open up new opportunities

Trust yourself, trust the process and the rest will take care of itself.

Post 2

New York City is a marketer's dream! The city is full of creative and interesting ads from companies ranging from large fortune 500s to up and coming startups.

Below are some of my favourites that I wanted to share. I'll post a part 2 since there are so many

Anthropic: NYC Ferry takeover + boards in the city.
Tubi: wild posting and taxi tops
Public: street corner take over
Notion: subway station takeover
Ramp: MTA takeover and bus wraps

Post 3
Every time a consulting client moved on, it felt like failure

I'd be working with a client for 8-10months as Fractional Head of Growth and eventually the time would come where it was time to hire someone internally.

At first, I thought this was a failure. I "lost" a client! I wasn't adding enough value!

But as I was pitching a new client and explaining how my engagements typically work, they had this awesome reframe:

You didn't lose a client, they "graduated"

Huh. What a great way to look at it!

My job as a Fractional HoG isn't meant to be permanent! Its meant to build the systems, foundations, models, channel mix etc of the Growth team such that they can eventually hire a full-time Head of Growth.

I'll even help you hire them!

I started reframing losing a client to having them "graduate" and its done wonders for how I pitch and how I think about my business day to day

I'm proud to say I've had 5 clients graduate over the past 2 years 🎓

Post 4

2 years ago today, I said goodbye to my 6 figure salary in the middle of one of the worst job markets in tech

Knowing thousands of folks were getting laid off and marketing budgets were being slashed to $0 was a bit nerve racking to say the least.

But

I reasoned that companies still needed to grow and I could help them do that.

Especially when they were looking to cut costs, I could be a great alternative to a fulltime hire or expensive agency.

And its been the best 2 years of my career (so far)

More than anything, I'm feeling immense gratitude:

- To all my clients who trust me with their business
- To the people who've been there when things were tough
- To anyone who has referred me clients (whether or not it worked out)

Your trust, consideration and support mean the world to me - thank you 🙏

Post 5

As we start to close out the year, folks in my network are still hiring for Growth roles ⬇️

- Mark Goad (GM Canada, Alan) - Growth Marketing Associate

- Rui Nunes (VP Marketing, Ascend FS) - Head of Growth, Product Marketing Manager, Lifecycle Manager, Media Planner and more!

- Cyrus Roepers-Chamlou (Co-Founder Influxion Point) - Sr Media Buyer

Interested in learning more? Feel free to DM me for an intro 🙂

Post 6

I stopped posting on LinkedIn for 2 months and something interesting happened

I had my highest grossing month ever

Thats weird.

I stopped doing marketing and 2 months later I have my biggest month ever?

I thought about where the newer leads were coming from that made this happen.

I've been at this for just over 2 years and I realized the flywheel is starting to spin.

I'm getting referrals from present and past clients, past clients are coming back for new projects and my content and LinkedIn presence is still getting viewed (despite my break).

It's been encouraging to see that all the work and hustle I've been putting in has been paying off!

It's a hell of a time getting that wheel turning, but once it starts, its all worth it

Keep going 💪🏽

Post 7

I made a mistake that almost cost my company over $200,000

A few years ago, I was running a series of new channel experiments, trying to find additional channels to scale beyond Facebook. One of those channels was local TV.

We had spent over $150,000 on the media buy, another $50,000 on the actual commercial (production, actors etc), had the custom landing page up and now it was go time - the ad was live in select markets across the US!

There was only one problem….

A few days in, I was checking the promo code redemption numbers in our dashboard and was alarmed to see 0 redemptions.

Did the campaign completely fall flat? Had I screwed up the media buy?

Upon further investigation, I realized that I hadn't enabled the promo code in our backend! All these people were coming to the site trying to redeem a promo code that didn't work 🤦🏾

I quickly enabled the promo code and immediately told Sean and Leonardo what had happened. Thankfully they were very understanding and we laughed about it - mistakes happen and it could've been much much worse.

Needless to say, from that moment on I always triple checked the promo codes 😂

Post 8

The trend around fractional roles is real and here to stay

Although the idea of a part time or fractional role is not new, in the last couple years its really taken off

Up until recently, a lot companies didn't realize that this type of role even existed!

A lot of the conversations I have generally start with a "How do you typically work with companies?" When I mention the fractional head of growth offering, they want to learn more. Turns out, in many cases, thats exactly the role they are looking for!

What I think is going on here is a case of TAM expansion.

What do I mean by that?

When Uber first launched, investors looked at that and said "ok the TAM for taxis / private car hire is x. Uber needs to capture y% of the market to be successful"

What many didn't realize at the time was that Uber grew the pie for taxis and then took a slice of this larger pie. They got people who drove everywhere to start taking Ubers and increased the market for taxis as a result.

Similarly (and I know this is a stretch), if you were to look at the % of companies open to hiring a part time marketing leader, the % would probably be very low.

But, now with a lot of great talent striking out on their own as fractional leaders and as companies learn more about the offering, the TAM for “part time marketing leader” has grown.

tldr, the fractional role is here to stay!

Post 9

Yesterday, I turned 30.

The past couple years have been transformative - from doing the digital nomad thing, to quitting my job and starting George St Growth.

As I start my 30th year, I’m starting to see the benefits of the past few years of risk taking and change - a theme that I have a feeling will continue.

5 things I’ve learned along the way

Your network is your net worth

As cliche as this is, its 100% true. I had two summer internships in Toronto before moving here in the fall of 2016. From my first summer here, I went to every event, met as many people as I could, and threw myself into the startup scene.

The relationships I’ve built over the past 7 years have been the building blocks on which I’ve built my entire career.

Take care of yourself

Getting enough sleep, eating well (ish), exercising and going to Othership are all things I try to do regularly to keep myself feeling good so I can consistently show up as my best self.

This is even more important now that I’m out on my own. Show up to a prospective client call not having slept well the night before and screw up the pitch? That poor sleep may have cost you the contract!

Be kind

The world is complicated, people are fighting battles you don't know about and frankly, we need more kindness in the world. If you come from a place of kindness, generosity and curiosity, nine times out of ten that will be reciprocated.

Give people the benefit of the doubt.

Life is short, life is long. Do whatever you want, there are no rules

Ask that person on a date, start that business, quit your job and travel! Life is short, don't waste it living it in a way that is not 100% true to you. If something doesn't work out, at least you tried! In the grand scheme of things, whats 3 months or 1 year? Life is long.

There is no one way to live, no rulebook to follow. Do what you want.

Compounding is everything

In many aspects of life, if you put in the reps for a long enough period of time, you'll see those benefits compound over time. Whether its relationships (see above), money, the gym, your skills etc, so much of life is showing up every day and putting in the work.

Do that for long enough and its pretty likely you'll succeed.

Post 10

When I first started George St Growth, I didn't know what I wanted it to be

Did I want to be an agency? A freelancer?

I was thinking maybe do it for a year (if it worked) and then call it a day.

Here we are just over a year later and I've landed on soloprenuer.

Not quite agency, not quite freelancer, just a guy with a business trying different things and sharing what he knows 😂

To that end, I wanted to share my updated website which I hope does a better job of explaining what I do and who I am.

Take a look and let me know what you think - link in comments! You may even notice a hint of whats to come 👀

Post 11

My philosophy when working with clients in a nutshell

I want to be the type of partner that I most enjoyed working with when I was in house.

What does that look like?

✅ No contracts: I'm happy to sign NDAs or whatever contracts are needed on the client's end, but I don't require any paperwork. I've worked with clients based on an email or a call.

✅ No minimums: i'll never lock you in to a multi-month or year long commitment. If you don't like working with me, just let me know.

✅ Fixed rate pricing: if I'm doing media buying, I'll never charge a % of spend, just a fixed rate.

✅ No bullshit: I'm a straight shooter. If things aren't going well, I make a mistake, or you ask for my feedback on something, I'll tell you what I think. The best client relationships are the ones where you're on the same team working towards a common goal.

In the end, what matters is results.

Running my engagements this way focuses everyone on the actual work and the results, builds trust quickly and has led to more enjoyable and impactful partnerships.

Post 12

My first year in business has gone pretty well! I've learned a ton, made a bunch of mistakes, and have been lucky enough to work with some amazing clients.

But whats next?

In addition to continuing my client work, there are a few other things I have in the works or have been thinking about

1️⃣ Working with the team at Otter to get my bookkeeping and accounting under control. As I've mentioned before, that has been the number one pain point for me, so I'm excited to help solve that problem 📚

2️⃣ I'm hoping to launch a digital product before the end of the year, filling a gap in the market that I see with some of my knowledge. More to come 👀

3️⃣ I'm currently hard at work updating my website. I first launched it when I had no idea what I wanted to be (agency or solo) and haven't touched it since 🌐

4️⃣ I've been having a great time on LinkedIn, but I'm starting to think about channel diversification for next year. Maybe some form of media (podcast / newsletter) or building a presence on another platform 🎙️

5️⃣ Continuing to travel, but likely fewer places with more intention and specifically more time in New York 🗽

More to come on all of the above but this is me putting it out there partly as a form of public accountability 😂

Post 13

6 months ago, I wrote a post with 5 things I was thinking about as the business was starting to take off (link to post in comments).

I thought it would be fun to revisit these 6 months later and see what progress I have (or haven't made):

1️⃣ Agency vs Solo: I followed my gut on this one and stayed solo. One thing I'm learning and need to think through a bit more is solo doesn't mean you can't bring on folks to help on a temporary or specific basis, it just means no FTE or traditional agency structure.

2️⃣ Where to focus my time outside client work: the LinkedIn experiment has been a success! I've been really enjoying it and met some awesome people, so this is where I've been doubling down.

3️⃣ How to meet more entrepreneurs: to the point above, I've found that putting myself out there on LinkedIn and irl talking about the things I'm interested has generally attracted the right kind of people. That plus being intentional about the events and meetups I've attended has really helped.

4️⃣ How to better leverage my VA: no progress. I need to give this one more thought - its a huge opportunity that I'm missing

5️⃣ What are principles of the business: no progress on this one either. I've thought about it but have yet to put pen to paper.

Progress on 3/5 - not bad! These are areas I'm going to keep working on and hopefully at the next 6 month mark I can say progress has been made on all 5!

Post 14

Today marks exactly 1 year since incorporating my business

Roughly 5 years ago, I set a goal for myself: I wanted to make a go of starting my own business before I turned 30. I was one year early!

More generally, throughout my life I've always defined professional success very simply: entrepreneurship. The people I looked up to the most, who I wanted to be when I "grew up" and how I thought about success was all about that one thing.

It wasn't about a certain salary, a fancy title, # of employees etc it was simply about being someone who took a bet on themselves and made a go of it.

Maybe later I'll write a "things I learned" post but today I just wanted to say thank you. I'm feeling immensely grateful to everyone who has supported me and helped me get to this point.

And a huge huge thank you to all my clients past and present who trust(ed) me with helping them grow their business - its a responsibility I take very seriously and will continue to work everyday to keep earning your business.

Much more to come

Post 15

How to turn Out of Home into a performance channel

In my previous post, I talked about how and why you should consider testing OOH as a new performance channel. The final (and arguably most important) piece is measurement.

Measurement can be done in two ways: lift pre/post and direct attribution.

Lift pre/post: as the name suggests, you can look at a few KPIs pre campaign, during and post the campaign to understand what happened.

Those KPIs are 1) avg # of weekly conversions in the given FSA or zip 2) top of funnel metrics like direct/organic website visits, branded search console queries and SEM branded search volume. You could even look at things time on site and change in the % of new vs returning visitors to understand if you're reaching new customers.

Looking at both TOFU metrics as well as comparing conversion numbers will give you a sense of how the campaign performed. For example, even if it didn't drive as many direct conversions as you would've hoped, its still important to understand if you're getting traffic lift.

Direct attribution: depending on the creative and the approach, this can look like promo code redemptions, custom URL visits and conversions (ex. short URL on the board that expands out to a

URL with a UTM or simply a custom landing page) as well as a checkout survey. Of the three, the checkout survey is the absolute must have.

By piecing together both pre/post lift analysis as well as direct attribution over time, you can get a really good sense of how your campaign performed.

From there, simply layer on your spend week by week and you'll have a CPA similar to how you would for any other performance channel!

Post 16

In the past 5 years, I've spent over $1m+ on Out of Home campaigns across North America. A few things I've picked up along the way…

If done correctly, Out of Home can be used as a performance channel with a CAC similar or even lower than "traditional" digital channels like Search and Facebook. It also has the added benefit of increasing brand awareness and brand trust.

There are three factors that make for a successful, performance based OOH campaign:

1️⃣Budget: you need to spend enough to actually create a lasting impression and give people the time to convert. But if you want to keep your CAC down, you can't spend too much, otherwise you'll oversaturate the market and needlessly drive up your CAC. Budget varies depending on season, geo and placement.

💡 Tip: Running a campaign in Q1 will get you much better bang for your buck vs other times of year. You can stretch your money further with better placements and longer leave up time. Regardless of when you buy, negotiation is critical to getting the best prices and ultimately, the best CAC.

2️⃣Media Planning: this includes everything from what placements you're going to buy, the actual creative, and where you're going to buy.
Placements: if you're looking to drive conversions, you need high dwell time media with high frequency. Think subway placements, transit shelters, restobar etc combined with high frequency placements like select billboards or taxi tops.

Creative: the simpler the better. For performance based campaigns, something simple and eye catching with a strong CTA, large logo and visible URL, promo code or other prompt for action.

Where to buy: where you buy is critically important. Look at where your best customers live, and target those areas (as narrow as zip code, FSA etc). Alternatively, or additionally, if you have a very specific target demo, you want to blanket the area where they live, work and/or play. You want your target customer to feel like your brand is everywhere and for folks outside your target, that you don't exist.

3️⃣Measurement: any performance marketer will know that measurement is critical in determining success of a campaign and OOH is no different. Measurement can be done in two ways: lift pre/post and direct attribution. Combined, you can get a pretty good sense for what happened.

Measurement is a big topic so I'll tackle that in a separate post later this week

As you think about your channel mix and how you can deliver incremental growth, consider giving Out of Home a try - you may be surprised by the results 🙂

Post 17

Over the past 6 months or so, I've noticed that more and more people have taken the leap and go out on their own.

It's been so fun to watch friends and folks I know go out and pursue their dreams and take that swing. Whether it's starting a company, a consulting practice, going fulltime into a passion like music or quitting their job to take that trip they always wanted, I'll always be cheering for those that break from the mould, that choose their own adventure or take risks.

If you're thinking of taking the leap or already have, I'm always happy to chat to see how I can help!

Post 18

One of the questions I get most frequently from people looking to try the Digital Nomad life is "where should I stay?"

Over the past year and a half, I've tried all kinds of different arrangements, from Coliving via Outsite, to the hostel + cowork combo of Selina to the classic Airbnb and managed apartment. This is what I've learned.

In a nutshell, places like Selina and Outsite are great for meeting people, but you pay a hefty premium for it. In my opinion, these are great options in small beach or surf towns where they are the centre of social life and a gathering spot for everyone (ex. Sayulita, Playa Venao etc).

In the big cities, particularly nomad hotspots like Buenos Aires, Medellin, Mexico City etc, you're better off in an Airbnb or managed apartment, especially if you're staying 1 month or longer.

Why? Per night, its cheaper and you get more! A full kitchen, bedroom, dining / living space etc. And many places, particularly the managed apartments you can find on sites like Booking .com or directly through Facebook / WhatsApp groups will also offer daily or weekly cleaning service.

But how do you meet people? In these cities, there is already a huge nomad community! You can go to meetups organized via Nomadlist, check Meetup .com, search Facebook for digital nomad in x city, ask around about WhatsApp groups (there are always a ton - foodies, parties, meetups etc) and in very short order you'll have a thriving social life!

This is the approach that I've used and its worked out fairly well! It definitely requires you to be a bit more proactive, but I've found that it strikes the right balance for me!

Post 19
I'm currently in Buenos Aires and went to a meetup last week where I met a fellow digital nomad who shared some great wisdom with me

She said "its very hard to build the business and travel at the same time. There are seasons in life and in your career and you just have to know which one you're in"

This was part of a much longer conversation, but it really made me think. The first 6 months of getting George St Growth off the ground was all about building. Getting clients, figuring out bookkeeping and how to actually run a business, building my marketing engine etc.

The last couple months have been more about taking my foot off the gas and seeing where I'm at. Making sure I'm doing the best I can for my clients, getting a better handle on my capacity and what I can realistically take on, and of course, taking some time to travel, see the sites, and meet people!

In the Spring, we'll be back in "building mode" but it was a good reminder to myself that you don't need to be going at 120% at all times.

(Photo below is from San Pedro de Atacama, Chile)

Post 20

As I hit the 6 month mark of being in business and meeting more folks who are either striking out on their own as consultants, starting companies or are already in the thick of it, its forced me to start to reflect. In no particular order, these are some of the questions I'm thinking about:

1. Do I want to build out an agency or stay solo? My gut is telling me stay solo but the opportunity is there

2. Where should I be focusing my time outside client work? LinkedIn is one area that I've been experimenting with that I've really been enjoying. But I'm still thinking about other levers I can use to grow (newsletter, podcast etc)

3. How to surround myself with more entrepreneurs and self employed folks? I've learned so much from chatting with and hanging out with folks at a similar stage, I want to double down on this!

4. How to better leverage my VA? I have a wonderful assistant who helps with reporting and admin but I feel like I could probably delegate a lot more.

5. What are the principles through which I want to run this business? I have a sense but I feel like this is something I need write down and formalize to help guide my decision making (h/t to Peter Sum for the inspo on this one)

I'm looking forward to slowly working through these and seeing where they lead - its all part of the process! And ofc, very open to thoughts, feedback etc either publicly or via DM :)

Post 21

Last week marked 6 months since leaving my fulltime job and going solo with George St Growth, so wanted to share a little update.

As with my previous post, this is definitely not an advice post! Although I've continued to learn, I'm not even close to being an expert (bookkeeping continues to be the absolute worst!)

A few things I've learned:

1. Trust the process, trust your network and keep going: clients come and go, budgets change and plans change.

If you keep putting in the work, delivering for clients, publishing content and sending those follow ups, things will happen for you!

2. Focus: I'm still learning this one! Being on your own is hard but rewarding.

I've realized that it requires a certain level of focus beyond just delivering for clients. You need to focus on the actual business too! I'm still working on this one and will have more to share soon :)

3. You need time to work ON the business, not just work IN the business:

I can't pack my time 100% with client work as I need time to work on the business, whether thats bookkeeping (the worst!), creating LinkedIn content or planning for the future. Otherwise, you're just treading water.

I'm incredibly grateful to all my clients past and present for trusting in me and being patient as I learn the ins and outs of running this business, its been quite the ride!

Later this week I'll post a follow up about some of the things I've been thinking about and some possible paths forward.

Post 22

Last year around this time, I set off on what became a deeply impactful and life changing trip.

To keep it short, this is what it looked like:

- 1 month in Medellin, Colombia with a group of folks from Unsettled
- That 1 month turned into 3 turned into 6
- I found myself traveling and working across Colombia, Mexico, Panama and the US.

Over that time, I met a ton of locals (some of whom remain friends to this day) and fellow travellers working and traveling the world.

That trip is ultimately what gave me the confidence to strike out on my own, having met so many people who had already taken the plunge was inspiring - it really pushed me to see what was possible.

From being conversational in Spanish, to starting my own business, having a new found love for Colombia (folks like Rob Hoffman and Matt Gray were way earlier than me on this one!) and discovering a new way to work and live, it really was transformational.

Last week, I set off again (this time only for 3 months) with stops in Colombia, Chile and Argentina and am looking forward to what this next adventure will bring.

As for after that? Who knows. For now, I'm enjoying the journey.

Ultimately, life is what you make of it. There are no rules. If you have the opportunity or the ability to give the digital nomad thing a shot, I can't recommend it highly enough!

Post 22

Going out on your own is so risky!

Is it?

We're seeing layoffs in tech every other week. Big companies, small companies, it seems almost constant.

With a fulltime salaried job, you definitely have stability…unless you're let go.

Then your income goes from 100 → 0 immediately.

As a solopreneur, I have multiple revenue streams and multiple clients.

The ups and downs are more frequent for sure, but if I lose a client, I'm not at 0! I still have income coming in the door, giving me time to find a new client.

There are pros and cons to either arrangement and some people are more suited for one vs the other

But I'm not convinced that one is inherently more risky than the other - the tradeoffs are just different.

Post 23

Three key takeaways after spending 5 weeks in NYC

1️⃣ The density of interesting and ambitious people is unmatched

I came away from my time in New York feeling super inspired. It felt like everyone I met was doing something really interesting, whether personally or professionally.

I met folks who were starting or running companies, building a side hustle, exploring different ideas or experimenting with lifestyle design just to name a few.

2️⃣ The level of ambition is on a different level

Similarly, everyone I met pushed me to think bigger.

Whether it was around pricing, lifestyle design, revenue, or new ideas, every conversation was met with a "yes and".

Yes and have you thought about x?
Yes and what if you tried y?

I'm leaving with an abundance mindset and a feeling that opportunity is everywhere.

3️⃣ Its an intense place to live

NYC is expensive. Its crowded. Its loud. Over time, these things definitely wore me down.

By the end, I was feeling really tired and in need of a break.

Since I only had just over a month, I really tried to make the most of it. I was going at 150% the entire time.

1-2 meetings or events Mon to Fri every week.

Obviously that level of intensity is not sustainable, so on my next visit I'm definitely going to try and take it a bit easier!

To everyone I met and everyone I had the chance to reconnect with - thanks for making it such a fulfilling and inspiring trip!

See you soon!

Post 24

Reflecting on the last 2 years as a Fractional Head of Growth, I try to remember why I got into this in the first place

Its easy to get sucked in to the world of Twitter and LinkedIn gurus posting Stripe screenshots, talking about how many employees they have, how much money they make etc

Every time I notice myself feeling like I'm not "measuring up" or haven't achieved the same level of "success," I think about what "success" actually means to me and why I got into this

Over the past 2 years I got to live my life on my own terms - making more money and working less (sometimes 😂)

Ok, so why did I get into this then?

✅ Having the flexibility to work and travel (and escape the winter!)
✅ The ability to decide who I work with and what I work on (and doing it well!)
✅ Prioritizing my health, my relationships and the things that bring me joy

I may not have the most employees or the most revenue but

I have a consistent gym routine and am in the pool 3x a week

I traveled to 6 countries and was out of the country for 5 months

I've been able to prioritize my relationships (ex attending my friend's citizenship ceremony in the middle of the day)

That's enough for me 🤘

(pic below was my first time at Olive Garden in California...I was pretty pumped to go)

Post 25

Growth job roundup!

I've been approached by a number of folks looking to hire for Growth roles in the last couple weeks so figured I'd share here for my broader network in case anyone was looking

Growth Lead at Requity Homes - Ben Yoskovitz
Marketing Lead at Haloo - Julie MacDonell
Account Director at No Growth - James Zhao
Performance Marketing Manager (SEM, FB) at Baselane - Thorben Scheidegger

Happy to intro or reach out directly!

Post 26

One of my biggest learnings from the past year? Get out of the house

Although I have a great setup at home, I find I'm not as productive at home more than 2-3 days a week.

I need a change of scenery and need social interaction to feel motivated and productive.

That's why over the last few months I've really made an effort to go to WeWork or a coffeeshop at least 2-3 days a week and I'm doubling down in 2024!

Shoutout to Tim Johnson for getting me back out!

Remote work is more than just wfh, its work from where you're most productive!

Just a me thing or do other folks feel the same?

Post 27

One area that's often overlooked when it comes to OOH

Promoting retail and pop up shops.

You've likely seen the big billboards on the side of the highway with the golden arches informing you that the next McDonalds is only 500m away or at Exit 52

But what about for challenger brands? For brands that may not have a permanent retail presence?

The answer is yes.

I was talking to Aashish recently and he was explaining to me how not enough brands are leveraging OOH to promote their retail activations.

One of the superpowers of OOH is the hyperlocal, physical nature of the media.

Running a pop up for a couple weeks or a month downtown?

Buy a few boards, posters and an A frame pointing people to the location and letting them know you exist!

Especially for pop ups and temporary retail locations, you want to maximize the time you have in the space. This is a cheap and easy way of doing that

Have you seen this work before? Any brands come to mind that have done this well?

Post 28

One of my goals for 2024 was to join a mastermind group

I'm happy to say mission accomplished (Thanks Ali Abbas for organizing)

1️⃣What is a mastermind group?

In a nutshell, its a group of people that are all working on similar things at a similar stage.

Its a place where you can share what you've learned and confidentially and openly talk about challenges you're facing.

More formalized versions of these include Hampton, EO, YPO etc

2️⃣Why

Working on your own can get lonely! Plus, not everyone around you understands the challenges you're facing.

Having a group of likeminded people that meet regularly to talk through these challenges and support each other has been a huge level up.

3️⃣Impact

In 2 months I've:

✔️ Gotten a better sense of how other folks price and structure contracts

✔️ Learned how I can better leverage my VA

✔️Got some guidance on how to structure a contract for a specific client.

If you're an entrepreneur at any stage, I'd highly recommend finding or creating your own version of this!

Post 29

One thing I wish I knew before going out on my own

When you go out on your own, all the traditional guardrails and paths disappear.

It is now up to you to define success, to take control of your professional growth and feel like you're progressing.

This is something I struggled with for a while.

How can I make sure I'm still learning and growing?

How can I ensure that I'm still "progressing" in my career when I've jumped off the ladder?

A few things I've learned:

✅ Building the business is itself a ton of learning and growth, even if it doesn't feel like it at the time

✅ Taking on projects that are a bit outside your comfort zone will push you to level up

✅ Joining a community or mastermind with other likeminded folks (formally or informally) will help you level up on the business side

Ultimately, it can be a bit disorienting but if you take the time to set your own guardrails and your own path, you'll come out the other side with a business and life that you love

Post 30

I'll tell you a story I haven't shared before…how I made $25,000 on the internet as a high school student.

Growing up, I always had an interest in computers and the internet, and I always had a knack for business.

When I was 13, I discovered Wordpress.

I had been going to computer camp and learned the basics of HTML and CSS.

I was also a huge fan of the show House with Hugh Laurie.

I decided to create a fan site with a .wordpress. com domain where I would link to the latest trailers, episode previews and created an episode guide.

On my 14th birthday, my parents got me 1 year of shared hosting with Bluehost so I could move my site from .wordpress.com to its own domain.

I would spend hours linking back to my new website on all the fan forums and tv show forums and websites trying to get people to come visit my site.

I didn't know it at the time, but I was building backlinks along with some basic keyword optimization on the site.

I was ranking #1 on Google for a bunch of different search terms.

I added banner ads, pop ups and signed up for an affiliate program with Commission Junction to sell House t-shirts and merch to monetize the site.

I'll never forget that first cheque for $1.03 that was mailed to me from Google AdSense.

From that moment forward, I was hooked.

My parents thought it was a cute hobby until the cheques started changing from $10 to $1,000.

I would stay up until midnight or 1am the night the latest episode aired so I could get the trailer for the next episode up on the site before anyone else.

I tried the same playbook with two other shows, neither of which took off.

Around the same time, I also dabbled in reselling on eBay, but thats a story for another day.

By the end of first year university as the show was winding down, I had made $25,000.

That money is what paid for some of my living expenses through school as well as my exchange in the Netherlands

That was my first taste of entrepreneurship and making money on the internet and I've been hooked ever since!

(pic below is me around that time wearing one of the tshirts I was selling via CJ!)

Post 31

What exactly is a Fractional Head of Growth?

I get this question a lot so wanted to break down what this looks like for me as someone who focuses primarily on Seed to Series A B2C

The joy of a role like this is that it can look like whatever the client needs! This is generally a mix of:

1️⃣Team or contractor management,
2️⃣Hands on keyboard operational (media buying, email building etc)
3️⃣Strategy (ex. building projections, setting targets, channel mix, funnel optimization etc).

These three things can flex in and out as needed. Its a super flexible role with the single goal of helping companies grow.

In nutshell, you get a Head of Growth part time for a fraction of the cost of a full time hire!

Post 32

2024 was the year things finally started to click

The flywheel finally started spinning

Past clients started referring me, folks moved to different companies and brought me with them, and I've gotten a few really solid cold leads from LinkedIn.

This was the year I started trusting myself a little bit more. That hey, maybe I actually know a thing or two about this consulting thing!

I finally felt like I wasn't in survival mode, not sure where the next dollar was coming from.

As part of my annual review this year, I did a deep dive on the business and pulled out a few interesting facts and figures:

🍁 There is an element of seasonality to the business, with 40% of revenue earned in the first half of the year and 60% of revenue earned in the second half with Q3 being the busiest quarter.

👨‍💼 I worked with 13 clients across 6 industries in Canada and the US. Some clients I've been working with for a year or more, others were small consulting or media buying projects that lasted just a couple weeks.

📊 I had a nice mix of client work with 38% doing traditional media buying, 31% doing Fractional, and 31% doing digital media buying.

Some other fun stats:
🏊 I spent 167 hours in the pool
🧊 I did 46 cold plunges
✈️ I spent 2 months of the year out of the country

A huge thank you to all my clients past and present for trusting me with your business. I'm incredibly grateful that I get to do this and don't take that responsibility lightly.

Looking forward to a great 2025 🎆

(h/t Jason Faber for the post idea)